

Mountains split. Boats connect.



Mountains kept towns apart. The sea helped people travel and trade.

- Each city-state had its own government.
- Rocky land made farming hard.
- Boats brought food and goods from other places.

city-state (polis): A city that rules itself and the land around it. civilization: A developed society with its own way of life.

YOUR TURN

Point to the mountains. Why did separate city-states grow?

- A. Mountains made it hard to reach other towns.
- B. Every town shared the same king.

Up for temples. Down for shopping.



Two places. Two jobs. Look UP at the acropolis. Look DOWN at the agora.

- Acropolis: a protected hilltop with temples.
- Agora: a public place to shop, meet and talk.
- Athens' Parthenon was a temple to Athena.

acropolis: The fortified hilltop. Say: uh-KROP-uh-lis. agora: The marketplace and meeting place. Say: AH-guh-ruh.

YOUR TURN

You need a new clay pot. Where would you go?

- A. The acropolis
- B. The agora

Athens or Sparta?



ATHENS: learn and create

SPARTA: train and obey

Athens trained minds. Sparta trained soldiers.

- Athens: learning, art, music and new ideas.
- Sparta: strength, discipline and obeying orders.
- Spartan boys left home for military training at seven.

Women in neither city could vote. Spartan women had more freedom.

YOUR TURN

Which child is more likely to practice public speaking and music?

- A. An Athenian schoolboy
- B. A Spartan boy in military training

Illustration for learning, not an exact historical reconstruction.

Who gets to decide?

Democracy

Citizens decide.



Oligarchy

A small group rules.



Tyranny

One ruler seizes power.



Democracy: citizens decide. Oligarchy: a few people rule. Tyranny: one ruler takes power.

- Athens: eligible male citizens voted directly.
- Sparta: a small group held the main power.
- Not everyone in Athens was allowed to vote.

Citizen = rights and duties. Tyrant = seized power; not limited by law.

YOUR TURN

Could every person living in Athens vote?

- A. Yes, every resident could vote.
- B. No. Only eligible free Athenian male citizens.

Stories gave answers.



Greek myths explained the world and taught lessons.

- Thunder? A myth could connect it to Zeus.
- Stormy seas? A myth could connect them to Poseidon.
- Pandora's story explained troubles and hope.

mythology: A culture's collection of traditional stories.

YOUR TURN

In Pandora's story, what remained after troubles escaped?

- A. A shield
- B. Hope

Pericles helped Athens shine.



Pericles helped Athens shine during its Golden Age.

- He was an Athenian general and political leader.
- He supported citizens taking part in democracy.
- He backed great buildings, including the Parthenon.

Pericles: Say PAIR-uh-kleez. Think: peak Athens.

YOUR TURN

Which city did Pericles lead?

- A. Athens
- B. Sparta

Illustration for learning, not an exact historical reconstruction.

Ten words. Ten picture clues.

Use the click-through guide to flip these cards one at a time.



civilization

An organized society with arts, science, government and social structure.

Clue: A whole society and its way of life.



city-state (polis)

An independent city with its own government and the land around it.

Clue: A city that works like a small country.



acropolis

A fortified hilltop in a Greek city, often with temples and public buildings.

Clue: UP for temples and protection.



mythology

A culture's traditional stories that explain beliefs about gods, nature and the world.

Clue: Myths have meanings.



agora

A city-state's central public space for markets and meetings.

Clue: GO to the agora to gather and shop.



democracy

Government where citizens hold power, directly or through elected representatives.

Clue: Citizens decide.

Ten words. Ten picture clues.

Use the click-through guide to flip these cards one at a time.



oligarchy

Government controlled by a small group of wealthy or powerful people.

Clue: Only a few rule.



citizen

A person recognized by the government as having rights and responsibilities.

Clue: Rights AND duties.



tyrant

In ancient Greece, a ruler who seized power and was not restricted by law.

Clue: Took power; not always a bad leader.



Pericles

An Athenian general and statesman who led Athens during its Golden Age.

Clue: Pericles = peak Athens.

MAKE IT A GAME

You explain. Grown-up guesses.

Pick a word. Describe it without saying it.

Example: "I am high above the city. People go to my temples and shelter behind my walls."

Answer: acropolis.

A little each day.

TONIGHT / OCTOBER 7

15 minutes: the six pictures

Ask what she notices. Read the short idea. Let her explain it back. Try each quick check.

TOMORROW / OCTOBER 8

15 minutes, then a break

Use the ten word cards. After a break, try the click-through quiz. Review only the words she misses.

FRIDAY / OCTOBER 9

5 minutes: the tricky bits

Ask: mountains or boats? Athens or Sparta? Acropolis or agora? End with a few tricky words.

Picture answers: 1 A; 2 B; 3 A; 4 B; 5 B; 6 A.

Real quiz: 10 vocabulary questions (75 points) + five main ideas (25 points). Our click-through quiz uses three choices to keep practice simple.

Extra details: The click-through guide keeps the six readings' supporting details behind a reveal, including all twelve gods and the government facts. This print version holds the main learning points.

Canvas check: Review her completed Main Ideas Exit Ticket. The separate teacher-only file and key were not accessible.

[Open the teacher's study site and original readings](#)

Prepared October 7, 2026 from Kristi Myers' ParentSquare announcement, linked Study Tips, vocabulary slides and six readings. Illustrations and practice activities were created for this guide.